INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PENPOINTS AND PENHOLDER, CROWQUILL

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers crowquill penpoints in sets of twelve, each set complete with one crowquill penholder.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

GG-P-181 - Penholders, Writing.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes; Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:53Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Penholder. The penholder shall be in accordance with GG-P-181, type II.

3.2 Penpoint.

3.2.1 Design and construction. The penpoint shall be of the crowquill type and shall be constructed of carbon steel having suitable flexibility for the purpose intended. Penpoint shall have a nominal shank diameter of 1/8 inch and shall be designed to fit securely in the penholder. Penpoint shall be designed for fine line work in accordance with standard commercial practice, The penpoint shall have sufficient strength to withstand the test in 4.2.3.1 without cracking, breaking, or becoming bent.

3.2.2 Finish. Penpoints shall have a smooth, uniform finish and shall be free from cracks, checks, chips, rough points or edges, burrs, or blisters. Penpoints shall be suitably finished so that they show no corrosion when tested as specified in 4.2.3.2.

3.2.3 Identification marking. Penpoints shall be legibly and permanently marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection of penholders. Penholders shall be inspected and tested in accordance with GG-P-181.

4.2 Sampling and inspection.

4.2.1 Inspection of end item. Examine sample penpoints for the defects listed in table I. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-3, with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per hundred units. The sample unit (unit of product) shall be a set of 12 penpoints with penholder. Inspect 5 penpoints from each set in accordance with table I. The lot size shall be the number of sets offered for acceptance at one time.

TABLE I. Inspection for end item defects.

Examine	Defects
Design and construction	Penpoint not of crowquill type; does not have nominal shank diameter of 1/8 inch; does not fit penholder; not designed for fine line work.
Finish	Penpoint does not have smooth, uniform finish; not free from cracks, checks, chips, rough points or edges, burrs, or blisters.
Identification marking	Penpoint not legibly and permanently marked with manufacturers' name or trademark.

4.2.2 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:53Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Inspection for preparation for delivery defects.

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, or distortion of container.
Contents (exterior and interior container)	Number per container is more or less than required. Net weight exceeds requirements.

4.2.3 Tests. Sample penpoints shall be subjected to the following tests. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-2, with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units. The sample unit shall be one set and the lot size shall be the number of sets offered for acceptance at one time.

4.2.3.1 Penpoint strength test. Place a sheet of paper on a platform scale and insert an unused penpoint in the penholder. Hold the penholder in a vertical position, place the point of the penpoint to the paper, and gradually apply a downward force of 1 pound. Release after 5 seconds of full pressure and check for compliance with 3.2.1.

4.2.3.2 Corrosion resistance test. Place 3 penpoints in a boiling water solution containing 10 percent (by weight) sodium chloride. After 15 minutes remove penpoints and place in a water and sodium chloride (10 percent by weight) solution for one hour at room temperature (73.5° + 5° F.). Remove penpoints and, without wiping the adhering fluid off, allow to dry for 24 hours. Then examine penpoints and check for compliance with 3.2.2.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A & B.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging. One penholder and twelve penpoints shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665 or PPP-B-676.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging. Twelve unit packages shall be intermediate packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665 or PPP-B-676.

5.1.2 Level C. The penholder and twelve penpoints shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Intermediate packages in quantities as specified (see 6.1) shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed, waterproof sealed, and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Intermediate packages in quantities as specified (see 6.1) shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Intermediate packages shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest rates in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:53Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the unit, intermediate, and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the unit, intermediate, and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:53Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.